Naqvi (2012) in his analysis of migration and sacrifice for the 'Muhajir community' observes how 'sacrificial narrative in the present … embody memories of loss and suffering that exceed the rationality of the high-political arena' amounting 'to a collective political claim for belonging and recognition' (p. 478). While Naqvi's focus was on Muhajir identity and the narrative of loss and sacrifice for the first-generation immigrants, his observation also rings true of the generations that follow, where the 'imagined' suffering of grandparents and great-grandparents became a uniting force in defining one's Pakistani identity. On the one level there is pride in the sacrifices of one's family for a Muslim homeland, while on another level there is the added frustration of living in a country where an average citizen is not given his/her due, despite the sacrifices of one's forefathers. Ironically, recognition of the sacrifices of non-Muslims is absent from any of these narratives, where the Pakistani citizen is once again the Muslim who migrated to Pakistan in search of a better future for his/her family.

Civic identity, citizenship and the counternarrative

The definition of citizenship, of being Pakistani, predominantly focused on a religious Islamic identity, was to be expected given the emphasis on Islamic nationalism in the education curriculum. However, despite belonging to an education system that seldom encouraged critical thinking and questioning, students from universities both government and private, as well as teachers, were nonetheless vocal about the limitations of being a Pakistani today. The most dominant theme was '*first of all being a Muslim and then not acting like one!!!*' (Male, Student, Lahore). While the Muslim–Pakistani nexus was far from questioned in relation to citizenship, the lack of knowledge about Islam, about being a Muslim was one that was repeated by students in both private and government universities, as the primary reason for the dismal state of affairs in Pakistan today. The response to the question of 'What is the meaning of Pakistan?' during focus groups was often qualified with the statement '*It is supposed to be There is no God but Allah*', '*it is supposed to be Land of the Pure*' but really Pakistanis are not there yet: '*Need right kind of Islamic education. People don't know about religion. Need to agree on basic tenants of Islam and teach them. If there is disagreement over something, that should be excluded. People should select a scholar and read the translation of the Quran*' (Focus Group, Government University)[12]; '*I think religious education needs to be reconsidered. We need to know what religion says. People say a lot but what is the true version*' (Focus Group, Private University[13]).